

Ἀνώνυμος Ἀριστοτέλους Σοφιστικῶν Ἑλέγχων

Sophistical Refutations and the Anonymous Aristotelian Commentators

eul_aid: vls

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος Verse
Affiliation: [Aristotelian](#)

The anonymous author of a commentary on Aristotle's **Sophistical Refutations** was a philosopher likely active in the late antique or early Byzantine period, around the 5th or 6th century CE. This era was characterized by intense scholarly efforts to preserve and explain classical texts, particularly within schools following Aristotelian and Neoplatonic traditions. The author's identity is entirely unknown, a common fate for commentators whose works were transmitted without attribution.

The author's sole known work is a commentary on Aristotle's **Sophistical Refutations**, a logical treatise analyzing fallacious arguments. According to the available information, this commentary was composed in verse. This format is highly unusual, as philosophical commentaries from this period were almost exclusively written in prose. No other specific titles or details of the author's reported six works are attested in standard scholarly sources.

The historical significance of this figure stems from this unique formal choice. A verse commentary on a technical work of logic would represent a rare fusion of poetic and philosophical writing in the late antique scholarly world. More broadly, commentators from this period played a crucial role as teachers and interpreters, helping to systematize Aristotle's logic and ensure its transmission to later Byzantine, Arabic, and Latin traditions. This anonymous author would be part of that broad effort of preservation and explanation, though the alleged verse format would distinguish the work from the mainstream.

Works (6)

- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Ἀριστοτέλη Ἑλληνιστί · [Commentary-Aristotle in Greek](#) · 140 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὰ Σοφιστικά Ἑλέγχῃ · [Commentary-Sophistical Refutations](#) · 16 passages
- Σύντομος Παράδοσις τῶν τρόπων τῶν σοφιστικῶν · [Concise Tradition of Modes of Sophistic Importunities](#) · 3 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ Σοφιστικά Ἑλέγχῃ · [Scholia on Sophistical Refutations \(Recension A\)](#) · 73 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ Σοφιστικά Ἑλέγχῃ · [Scholia on Sophistical Refutations \(Recension B\)](#) · 58 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ Σοφιστικά Ἑλέγχῃ · [Scholia on Sophistical Refutations \(Recension C\)](#) · 211 passages

Other Aristotelian Authors

- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Alexander of Aphrodisias](#) · 16 works
- [Ἀνώνυμος εἰς τὰς Κατηγορίας τοῦ Ἀριστοτέλους · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος ἐν Ἠθικοῖς Νικομαχείοις · Anonymous Commentary on Aristotle](#) · 3 works
- [Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς · Apollonius of Aphrodisias](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀριστοτέλης · Aristotle](#) · 56 works